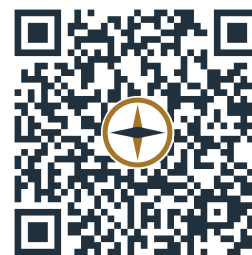




# Homeschool Credit Compass

The affordable college track, and transcripts colleges trust.

Scan the code (or type the address) for the full guide, links, and downloadable sample documents.



homeschoolcreditcompass.com

## THE COLLEGE TRACK

- **Modern States ([modernstates.org](https://modernstates.org))**

Free online CLEP prep courses taught by professors, plus a voucher that covers the exam fee. Finishing a course also makes a solid high school credit on the transcript.

- **CLEP exams: \$97, or \$0 with a voucher**

One exam can equal one college course (3 to 6 credits). No minimum age at a test center, so capable middle and high schoolers can start early (remote proctoring requires age 13+). A low score earns no credit but never affects a college GPA. Verify each exam with the destination college first: acceptance and minimum scores vary, and some cap how many credits by exam they take.

- **Dual enrollment**

Real college courses in high school, online or on campus, counting for both high school and college credit. Faith Baptist Bible College: \$150/credit plus a \$15/credit online tech fee (ask about the \$99 fall special). Cedarville, Bob Jones, Colorado Christian, and GCU (\$52.50/credit) also offer online options.

- **Iowa Last-Dollar Scholarship [Iowa only]**

Covers remaining tuition for eligible high-demand programs at Iowa community colleges and some accredited private Iowa colleges (healthcare, IT, trades, welding, early childhood, and more). FAFSA required; the SAI cap and eligible-program list change yearly, so check the current figures.

- **Christian Leaders Institute**

Free ministry and general-studies courses; low-cost degrees (about \$2,000 associate / \$4,000 bachelor's). CLI holds ABHE candidate (pre-accredited) status, not full accreditation. Credits transfer to Liberty University, subject to Liberty's normal transfer rules.

## TRANSCRIPTS

- **You are the school**

You issue the transcript, and colleges accept parent-issued transcripts. Iowa does not impose the public-school graduation-credit framework, though requirements vary by private-instruction option. Aim at the destination college's expectations, and check each college's homeschool transcript instructions.

- **Counting credits: 1 credit = about 1 year**

HSLDA standard: ~150 hours (academic) or ~120 (non-academic), a finished curriculum, or proven mastery (CLEP, dual enrollment). Fractions like 1/2 and 2/3 are normal.

- **Don't over-engineer it**

You can assemble the transcript in junior or senior year from casual notes. Keep notes somewhere as you go.

- **Real life counts**

Beekeeping, church tech booth, engine work: legitimate coursework once it's named. AI tools can help sort activities into courses, credits, and grades.

- **School profile**

A one-page companion document: philosophy, curricula, grading scale. Sample on the site.

- **Testing**

CLT (grades 3-8, CLT10, then CLT) works as a yearly benchmark. Iowa does not require every homeschooler to test annually, but some families face a progress evaluation. SAT/ACT stay most widely accepted, and many merit scholarships want them.

## NOTES

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## Paths, checklists, and links

### THREE POSSIBLE PATHS

#### 1. The CLEP Stacker

Modern States, then free CLEP exams, one subject at a time. Enter college with a bank of gen eds. Best for independent test-takers; can start as young as the student is ready.

#### 2. The Dual-Enrollment Track

Real college courses in high school (FBBC or a community college). Start light, ramp up senior year; summer terms pack well. Builds a college GPA.

#### 3. The Ministry / Budget Degree

Free CLI courses, low-fee degree, transfer to Liberty. Use CLEP to swap out gen eds under Liberty's transfer cap.

#### WORTH EXPLORING (not yet vetted)

GCU dual enrollment (\$52.50/credit) - Iowa Valley skilled trades (concurrent enrollment, Iowa) - College of the Ozarks (no tuition, work program) - Central Bible University - DSST - Sophia & Saylor - mikeroweWORKS - ACBC counseling - Agros - degree-by-exam.

### BEFORE ANY EXAM OR ENROLLMENT: THE VERIFY CHECKLIST

- ☐ Search "[college name] CLEP equivalency" and read the college's own table.
- ☐ Read the academic catalog / student handbook: transfer rules and credit-by-exam caps live there.
- ☐ Email the registrar with your student's intended major and planned exams; keep the written reply.
- ☐ Ask admissions where the freshman-vs-transfer line sits (freshman scholarships are usually the biggest money).
- ☐ Ask financial aid what a full package could cover before paying for dual-enrollment credits.

### LINKS WORTH TYPING

**modernstates.org** - free CLEP prep + exam vouchers

**faith.edu** - FBBC dual enrollment (\$150/credit)

**educate.iowa.gov** - Last-Dollar Scholarship details

**hslida.org/legal/iowa** - current Iowa homeschool law

**clep.collegeboard.org** - register for exams; credit policy search

**christianleadersinstitute.org** - free courses, low-cost degrees

**cltexam.com** - CLT tests and partner colleges

**gcu.edu** - GCU dual enrollment (\$52.50/credit)

### AI PROMPT STARTERS (Claude, ChatGPT, or similar)

#### Activities into credits:

"Here is a list of my student's activities and projects with rough hours. Suggest course titles, credit amounts (about 120 hours = 1 credit), subject areas, and a short course description for each. Flag anything too thin to count."

#### School profile:

"Here is a description of our homeschool: philosophy, curricula, grading, and anything unusual. Draft a concise, professional school profile an admissions office would find clear and credible."

### NOTES